# FIRST TIMOTHY

## Conversational Version

**Salutation**

**1:1**Paul, apostle of Christ[Messiah] Jesus by the authority of God our Savior and Christ Jesus our hope, **2**to Timothy *my* loyal son in the faith. Grace, mercy, *and* peace from God *the* Father and Christ Jesus our Lord. **1 Tim 1:1-2**

**Warning Against False Teachers**

**3**When I left for Macedonia, I urged you to stay in Ephesus to instruct certain people not to teach false doctrine **4**or pay attention to myths and endless genealogies. Those things lead to speculation rather than God's plan, which operates by faith. **5**The goal of instruction is love from a pure heart, a clear conscience, and sincere faith. **6**Some have turned away from these to empty talk and got lost. **7**They want to teach the Law, but they don't know what they're talking about so confidently. **1 Tim 1:3-7**

**Using the Law Lawfully**

**8**We know the Law is good if you use it 'lawfully.' **9**It's not there *so much* for good people, as for lawless, disorderly, godless, sinful, unholy, profane *people*. It's for murderers, for people that kill *their* fathers and mothers, **10**for immoral people, male homosexuals, kidnappers, liars, perjurers, and anything else that contradicts sound doctrine **11**as set forth in the glorious good news from our blessed God—the good news he entrusted me with. **1 Tim 1:8-11**

**Paul's Gratitude for Salvation**

**12**I'm grateful to Christ Jesus who has strengthened me and considered me worth trusting though I'd been a blasphemer, persecutor, insolent person. **13**I received mercy because I did it ignorantly in disbelief. **14**The Lord's grace overflowed with the faith and love that's in Christ Jesus. **15**There's a reliable statement that deserves full acceptance: *"Christ Jesus came to the world to save sinners and I'm the worst."* **16**I received mercy so Christ Jesus could use me to demonstrate *his* extreme patience. The "worst sinner" provided an example to people that would later trust in *Christ* for eternal life. **17**Now to the eternal King and only God, immortal, invisible *be* honor and glory forevermore! Amen. **1 Tim 1:12-17**

**18**I'm entrusting that instruction to you, Timothy *my* son. I'm doing it because of the prophecies about you early on so that on the basis of them you can fight the good fight **19**with faith and a clear conscience. Some have refused to listen to *their conscience* and have shipwrecked as far as faith is concerned. **20**Hymeneas and Alexander are *two examples*; I've delivered them to Satan to teach them not to blaspheme. **1 Tim 1:18-20**

**Attitude Toward Earthly Rulers**

**2**:**1**So I encourage prayers and thanksgiving for everybody—**2**kings and *other* people in authority—that we can lead a peaceful, quiet, godly life. **3**That's good and acceptable to God our Savior. **4**He wants everyone to learn the truth and be saved. **5***There's* one God and one Mediator between him and us, *the* man Christ Jesus, **6**who gave himself as a ransom for many, *as a* testimony given at the right time. **7**That's why he appointed me to be a herald and apostle, to teach Gentiles about faith and truth. That's the truth. **1 Tim 2:1-7**

**Men's and Women's Decorum**

**8**So I want believers everywhere to pray, holding up holy hands without anger or argument. **9***I want* women to dress modestly and decently, not with elaborate hairstyles, gold, pearls, expensive clothes. **10***They should 'dress'* in good deeds, which is appropriate for women that profess godliness. **11**They should learn in quietness and deference. **12**I don't let a woman teach or exercise authority over a man; she should remain quiet. **13**For Adam was formed first, then Eve; **14**and Adam wasn't deceived; the woman was deceived and fell into transgression. **15**But she'll be saved through *her* child-rearing *role*, if *her children* continue in faith, love, sanctification, and decency. **1 Tim 2:8-15**

**Caracteristics of Elders**

**3**:**1**It's a reliable statement: *"If anyone aspires to being an overseer, he's aspiring to do a good thing."* **2**He needs to be above criticism, faithful to his wife, moderate, sensible, respectable, hospitable, able to teach. **3***He must* not *be* pushy or addicted to wine. *He should be* gentle, not combative or greedy for money. **4***An overseer needs to* manage his family well; his children *need to be* obedient and well-behaved. (**5**If someone doesn't know how to manage his own family, how can he take care of God's church?) **6***He should*n't *be* a new convert; he can get proud and fall into the devil's condemnation. **7**He needs *to have* a good reputation among people that aren't Christians so he won't fall into disgrace and the devil's trap. **1 Tim 3:1-7**

**Characteristics of Deacons**

**8**Deacons, too, need to have good character, not be two-faced, addicted to a lot of wine, or greedy for dishonest gain, **9***men who* maintain the mystery of the faith with a clear conscience. **10**They should be examined first, then serve as deacons if they're blameless. **11***Their* wives need to have good character too, not be inclined to malicious gossip, *but* temperate, faithful in every respect. **12**Deacons need to be faithful to their wives, managing *their* children and family well.

[13]Deacons that serve well gain good standing and added boldness in the faith that's in Christ Jesus. **1 Tim 3:8-13**

[14]I'm writing to you in hopes of coming soon. [15]But if I'm delayed, *this way* you'll know how to conduct yourself in God's house, the church of the living God, the foundation and pillar of the truth. [16]Everybody agrees that the mystery of godliness is great:

*"He was revealed in flesh,*
*vindicated in spirit,*
*seen by angels,*
*presented among nations,*
*believed on in the world, and*
*taken up in glory."* **1 Tim 3:14-16**

**Future Heresies**

**4**:[1]The Spirit says that later on people will abandon the faith. They'll pay attention to deceiving spirits and demons' doctrines, and indulge [2]in the hypocrisy of liars that have a seared conscience. [3]*They'll* forbid marriage and require abstinence from food that God created for faithful people to receive with gratitude. [4]Everything he created is good, and nothing should be rejected if people that know the truth receive it gratefully. [5]God's word and *our* prayers sanctify everything he created. **1 Tim 4:1-5**

[6]If you point this out to the disciples, you'll be serving Christ Jesus well, and you'll be fed by the message about faith and the good teaching you've been following. [7]Stay away from profane, silly myths. Exercise yourself for godliness. [8]Bodily exercise profits a little, but godliness profits a lot because it promises life now and later. [9]The saying is reliable and deserves full acceptance: [10]*"We labor and struggle because we've placed our hope in a living God, everybody's Savior, especially believers."* [11]Teach and command that. **1 Tim 4:6-11**

**Timothy's Interim Ministry**

[12]Don't let anybody disregard you because you're young. Set an example for the faithful in what you say and do—in love, faith, purity. [13]Till I get there, give attention to the *public* reading *of scripture*, to encouragement, to teaching. [14]Don't neglect your spiritual gift that you received by prophecy and the laying on of hands by the eldership. [15]Cultivate it; immerse yourself in it so everybody will see your progress. [16]Pay close attention to how you live and to your teaching work. Stay true to the truth so you'll save yourself and your listeners. **1 Tim 4:12-16**

**Relating to Church People**

**5**:[1]Don't reprimand an elder; urge *him* like a father. Encourage younger men like brothers; [2]older women like mothers, and younger women like sisters, in purity. **1 Tim 5:1-2**

[3]Honor widows that don't have anybody to depend on. [4]If a widow has children or grandchildren, they should first learn to practice godliness toward their own family and repay parents; that's acceptable with God.

[5]A widow that's by herself has put her hope in God and continues in prayers and thanksgiving day and night. [6]But one that lives in self-interest is dead while she's alive. [7]Tell *widows* to be above criticism.

[8]If people don't take care of their own, especially *their* family, they've denied the faith; they're worse than disbelievers. **1 Tim 5:3-8**

**Guidelines for Welfare Recipients**

[9]Don't enroll a widow younger than 60, who was faithful to her husband, [10]with a reputation for doing good, who have raised children, shown hospitality, washed the saints' feet, helped people in distress, followed every good deed. [11]Don't enroll younger widows. While they're liable to physical interests, they'll want to remarry, [12]incurring criticism for setting aside their previous pledge *to Christ*. [13]At the same time, they can get in the habit of not doing anything, going around the neighborhood talking about things they shouldn't. [14]So I prefer younger *widows* to remarry, have children, manage the family—so they don't give critics a chance to find fault. [15]Some have already wandered off after Satan.

[16]If a believer[fem] has widows, she should take care of them so the church won't be burdened, and it can help widows that don't have anybody *to take care of them*. **1 Tim 5:9-16**

**Commandments About Leaders**

[17]Consider elders that do their work well to be worthy of double honor, especially the ones that teach. [18]The scripture says, ***"Don't put[sg] a muzzle on an ox while it's threshing"*** **[Deut 25:4]**, and, *"A worker's worth his wages"* **[Mt 10:10; Lk 10:7]**. [1]

[19]Don't accept an accusation against an elder except from two or three witnesses.

[20]Publicly reprimand people that keep sinning, so the rest will take heed as well.

[21]In front of God, Christ Jesus, and the elect angels, I solemnly charge you to keep these directives without showing favoritism to anyone.

[22]Be careful about laying hands on somebody too soon. Don't take part in other people's sins so you'll keep yourself untainted.

[23]Don't *just* drink water; use a little wine for your frequent bouts with an upset stomach.

[24]Some people's sins are obvious as they lead them into condemnation. *Other people's sins* become obvious *later*. [25]It works the same way with good things. The ones that aren't *obvious* will become obvious someday. **1 Tim 5:17-25**

**Servant-Master Relationship**

**6**:**1**Servants should fully respect their masters so God and *his* doctrine aren't slandered. **2**Servants with believing masters must not disregard them because they're equals; they need to serve them even more because the ones that are benefiting from their good service are faithful and loved. **1 Tim 6:1-2a**

**Consequences of False Teaching**

Teach[sg] and encourage *everyone to do* these things. **3**If anybody teaches something that doesn't agree with sound words from our Lord Jesus Christ and with godly teaching, **4**he's conceited and lacks understanding. He has an unhealthy desire to debate and arguments about words. Things like that produce jealousy, division, slander, suspicion, **5**constant arguing by people depraved in mind and deprived of truth. They think godliness is a way to gain wealth, **6**but godliness with contentment is a great gain. **7**We didn't bring anything into the world, and we can't take anything out. **8**Let's be content with food and clothes. **9**People that want to get rich encounter temptation, which traps *them* in foolish, harmful desires and drags them down to ruin. **10**The love for money is the root of all *kinds of* evil. Some that strain after wealth have wandered away from the faith and pierced themselves with many sorrows. **1 Tim 6:3-10**

**Keeping Morals and Priorities Straight**

**11**But, man of God, run away from wealth; pursue goodness, faith, love, perseverance, gentleness. **12**Fight the good fight of faith; take hold of the eternal life God called you to, the good acknowledgement you made in front of many witnesses. **13**I charge [you][ms] in front of God, who gives life to everything, and Christ Jesus, who acknowledged who he was in front of Pontius Pilate: **14**be spotless and without blame; keep the commandment until the Lord Jesus Christ comes. **15**At the right time he'll be revealed by

the blessed and only Master,
the King of kings and Lord of lords,
**16**who alone has immortality,
who lives in light so bright you can't approach,
that no one has seen or can see:
to him *be* honor and eternal dominion! Amen. **1 Tim 6:11-16**

**Words to the Wealthy**

**17**Instruct people that are wealthy now not to be proud or to have *their* hope based on the uncertainty of wealth. *Tell them to put their hope* in God, who supplies us richly with everything we enjoy. **18***Instruct them* to be rich in good deeds, *to be* generous, willing to share, **19**treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so they can experience what's truly life indeed. **1 Tim 6:17-19**

**Maintaining the True Knowledge**

**20**Timothy, guard what's been entrusted to you. Avoid profane, empty talk, and the opposing notions that come from knowledge falsely so-called. **21**Some have professed that knowledge and strayed away from the truth.

Grace *be* with you. **1 Tim 6:20-21**

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